

TVs

CHOOSING THE RIGHT TV FOR YOUR BUDGET



Insightful tips to go beyond specs and navigate your TV purchase

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hen it comes to TVs, the adage "Don't judge a gadget by its specs" couldn't be more true.

Popular specs that consumers can directly relate to or compare, like 4K UHD resolution, HDR, Dolby Vision, processor cores, and storage, remain consistent across a wide price band, often leading to confusion. The true magic of a TV lies in its real-world performance: the crispness of the picture, the depth of the blacks, the smoothness of motion, the accuracy of colors, and the sophistication of tone-mapping algorithms.

So, how do you go about choosing the right TV for your budget? There is no straightforward answer to this question except "read the reviews," but we will share a few useful insights to help you decide or at least better understand your preferences.

AFFORDABLE TVs

If you're looking for an affordable TV under Rs. 35,000, you'll mostly find 43-inch and 50-inch models, with a few

competitively priced 55-inch options. Legacy brands like Samsung, Sony, and LG, known for reliable performance, are usually limited to 43-inch displays in this price range.

All TVs in this segment use LED LCD panels, with some featuring Quantum Dot Enhancement Film (QDEF) marketed as QLED TVs. While QLED offers a wider colour gamut, the extra cost may not always be justified by the perceived improvement in picture quality.

Most affordable TVs in this range deliver around 300 nits of peak brightness, which isn't sufficient for impactful HDR highlights. However, HDR support can still provide a wider colour gamut. Occasionally, we encounter an improperly tuned affordable HDR TV that tone maps the content too dark or adds a weird tint to the picture.

Although many affordable TVs list HDMI 2.1 connectivity, they often do not support full HDMI 2.1 bandwidth. HDMI 2.0 is adequate for 4K @ 60Hz. Full HDMI 2.1 is needed only for high-resolution gaming at 120Hz. For gaming, look for HDMI 2.1 features

like Auto Low Latency Mode (ALLM). Regarding software, most TVs in this segment run Google TV, but proprietary interfaces like Amazon's Fire OS, LG's WebOS, and Samsung's Tizen OS are also good options. One thing to look for is that your TV software has well-tuned picture modes. Filmmaker or Cinema mode is recommended for accuracy, though some users prefer more vibrant profiles with cooler whites, which can be oversaturated on affordable TVs. Listed on the next page are some decent Affordable TVs that you can consider.

MIDRANGE TVs

In the mid-range segment, ranging from Rs. 35,000 to 85,000, you can find a wide variety of TVs up to 65 inches in display size. Legacy brands such as Sony, Samsung, and LG often offer lower prices in offline stores compared to online prices. Another interesting aspect of this segment is the availability of excellent deals on popular previous-generation TVs.

For display technologies, this segment offers numerous options including